Flip Crab

Light Crabstract Strategy for 2 players

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Game Overview

You and your opponent control a cast of Crabs. You are both racing to get 1 of your Crabs to the opposite Shore. Along the way your Crabs will dig up Rocks, bury Rocks, dodge Shark Shadows, and reposition your Crabs all to block your opponent from scuttling a Crab to your shore.

Each turn you'll choose 1 of your 3 Awake (standing on its feet) Crabs to use. After your turn, your Crab will move from Awake to Sleeping - push it onto its back. Your opponent then wakes up their furthest Sleeping Crab from the Crab you just used on your turn by standing their Sleeping Crab onto its feet. If there's a tie for distance in tiles away between their 2 Sleeping Crabs, your opponent chooses which one to become Awake.

Crabs are limited in their movement. Rocks and other Crabs block movement and Crabs can never move backwards towards their starting Shore.

2 Shark Shadows mark tiles where Crabs are unable to dig or bury Rocks.
Whenever a Crab digs a Rock, buries a Rock or moves to a tile where a Shark Shadow is, the Shark Shadow changes position in response.

Setup



Setup the board as shown in the picture.
Each player (Green & Pink) has 3 Shore tiles. Each Crab has a shell under it to show its player.
As Crabs move, move their shells with them to track which player the Crab belongs to.
Green starts with 2 Awake Crabs and 2 Sleeping Crabs.
Pink starts with 3 Awake Crabs and 1 Sleeping Crab.
Pink takes the first turn.

On Your Turn

Choose 1 of your Awake (standing on its feet) Crabs to use this turn. Do a scuttle, dig, or bury action with your chosen Crab. If you scuttled a Crab to 1 of your opponent's 3 Shore tiles, you immediately win. If none of your Crabs can complete a scuttle, dig, or bury action, you must pass.

Scuttle

- Move your Crab 1 or 2 tiles sideways or away from your Shore tiles.
    - Your Crabs can never move backwards towards your Shore tiles.
    - Crabs, Shells, and Rocks block movement.
- If your Crab moved to or through a tile where a Shark Shadow is, move that Shark Shadow to the tile your Crab started your turn on.
    - It is possible for 2 Shark Shadows to be on the same tile.

Dig

- Add a Rock to an empty tile (no Shark Shadow, Rock, or Crab) next to your Crab.
- You cannot add a Rock to a Shore tile.
- You cannot add a Rock to a tile where a Shark Shadow is.
- Move the nearest Shark Shadow onto the Rock.
    - If there's a tie for distances between the Rock and the nearest Shark Shadow, you choose which Shark Shadow moves.
    - It is possible for 2 Shark Shadows to be on the same tile.

Bury

- Remove a Rock adjacent to your chosen Crab.
- You cannot remove a Rock from a tile where a Shark Shadow is.
- Move the nearest Shark Shadow onto the tile you removed the Rock from.
    - If there's a tie for distances between the tile and the nearest Shark Shadow, you choose which Shark Shadow moves.
    - It is possible for 2 Shark Shadows to be on the same tile.

Pass

- You can only pass if none of your Crabs can complete a scuttle, dig, or bury action.
- Your chosen Crab will become Sleeping at the End of Your Turn as usual.

End of Your Turn

- The Crab you used becomes Sleeping. Push it onto its back.
- Your opponent's Crab furthest from the Crab you used becomes Awake. Your opponent stands it onto its feet.
    - If there's a tie for distance in tiles away between their 2 Sleeping Crabs, your opponent chooses which one to become Awake.